

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Laughter is ... the best medicine!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about staying healthy.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can talk about feelings and reactions.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think laughing is important for your health? Why or why not?
- Is laughter important in your life?
- When do you laugh?





Let's Explore!

Sally continues her health column in *Cambridge Life*. Today, she is writing about the importance of **laughter****.

* The word "laughter" is a noun. It comes from the verb *to laugh*.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

We all know that tension and worry often affect us physically. If you are under a lot of stress or feel tired, you may even develop an illness. If you are tense and worried all the time, you should try to find ways of relaxing. The mind affects the body.

When we feel relaxed, our bodies simply feel better and we can accomplish tasks more successfully. It's not always easy, but everyone should learn how to relax. Athletes, singers and actors are aware of this. Only when they relax can their minds and bodies perform well. It may seem surprising, but one standard drama school exercise that anyone can do is simply yawning. When you yawn and stretch, your body naturally relaxes itself. All you have to do is to seriously start pretending to yawn, and then your body will take over and you will really start yawning! It's an energizing experience.

Another wonderful way to relax is by laughing. Start laughing by just doing it, and then the body will naturally take over. Laughter is one of nature's gifts to human beings – and this is why it is often called the best medicine of all.





Let's Practice!

Let's practice these words related to health.

Instructions: Find the words in the word search. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Words

1. yawning
2. laughter
3. stretching
4. relax
5. tension
6. worry
7. stress
8. illness



Let's Practice!

Sally talks about feelings and the effect things have on us.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the corresponding adjective correctly (-ed or -ing), for each sentence. Use words from the word bank. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Word Bank

Confused / confusing / relaxing / relaxed / tired / tiring / surprised
surprising / energized / energizing

1. If you are under a lot of stress or feel _____, you may even develop an illness.
2. When we feel _____, our bodies simply feel better.
3. Yawning is an _____ experience.
4. It may seem _____, but one standard drama school exercise is simply yawning.
5. I'm feeling _____ about this problem. Can you help me?





Extension Activity

Share personal stories about the importance of laughter or other ways to stay healthy.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about a time when you used one of the strategies discussed in this lesson (laughter, stretching, yawning, etc.) to stay healthy.
- Share your experience with a partner.
- Listen to your partner's story.
- Go online to read about other people's stories on how they stay healthy.
- Discuss the stories with your partner. What do you find interesting or surprising about them?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I share a personal story related to health.

☐ ☐

I read and reflect on other stories.

☐ ☐

I discuss other stories.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to yawn** (verb): to breathe in a large amount of air due to fatigue
e.g. When you yawn, your body naturally relaxes itself.
- **tension** (noun): stress or pain in the body due to fatigue
e.g. We all know that tension affects us physically.
- **worry** (noun): concern over a problem or situation
e.g. Worry can also have an effect on our physical health.
- **to stretch** (verb): to move your limbs (legs, arms, etc.) to improve the flexibility of the muscles
e.g. When you stretch, your body finds a relaxed position.
- **to laugh** (verb): to respond to a comical situation with a natural reaction of the core body
e.g. Another wonderful way to relax is by laughing.
- **illness** (noun): the condition of being unhealthy or sick
e.g. People who are tense and worried over a long period of time may develop real illnesses.





Learning Points

Discussing How to Deal with Problems

To discuss how to deal with problems such as health issues, you can use modals like *might*, *could*, or *should*.

These modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "If ...".

The modal is followed by a verb in the base form. You do not use "to".

Examples:

- *If you are tense and worried all the time, you should try to find ways of relaxing.*
- *It's not always easy, but everyone should learn how to relax.*

Talking About Someone's Feelings and Reactions

You talk about feelings and reactions using adjectives.

Adjectives that end in **-ed** are used to describe how a person feels, like *relaxed*, *surprised*, *confused*, *worried*, *energized* or *tired*.

Adjectives that end in **-ing** are used to describe things and situations, like *relaxing*, *surprising*, *confusing*, *worrying*, *energizing* or *tiring*. These adjectives describe the *effect* something has on a person.

Examples:

- *Now, personality tests are something many people find fascinating.*
- *Yawning is an energizing experience.*

